



To: Selection Committee
KLU Kühne Logistics University

6 April 2026

V1.1: For Selection Committee / KLU Kühne Logistics University

Subject: Letter of Recommendation for Marcela Sánchez Vargas

Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

It is my great pleasure to recommend Ms. Marcela Sánchez Vargas for the Founding Campus Director position at KLU's Bogotá campus. I worked closely with Marcela for over seven years, during which she served as Administrative and Operational Director of CEMarin Corporation; an NGO I founded in Colombia.

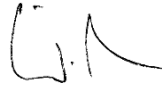
As Professor at Justus Liebig University Giessen, I witnessed Marcela's exceptional ability to bridge rigorous German institutional standards with Latin American operational realities. Her core strengths make her ideally suited for establishing KLU's presence in Colombia:

- Greenfield Institution Building: Marcela transformed CEMarin from a basic legal entity into a fully operational research corporation. She established five core departments from scratch, implementing strategic planning, hiring key personnel, and designing comprehensive internal governance structures.
- Financial Governance & Compliance: Marcela managed a €1M BMBF ColombiaCONNECT grant with 100% audit compliance, meeting the highest German (BMBF/DAAD) and international regulatory standards. Her financial oversight ensured flawless reporting across multiple funding streams.
- Operational Excellence Under Pressure: During COVID-19, Marcela led a seamless transition to 100% cloud-based operations while successfully orchestrating the ICMS 2020 Conference, attracting over 1,000 global participants despite pandemic challenges.
- Strategic Growth: Under her leadership, CEMarin achieved a 76% revenue increase (2020–2021) through diversified international funding and effective management of simultaneous projects.

(Wilke, 2026)

Marcela possesses the rare "founding mindset" combined with proven operational rigor needed to establish KLU's excellence in Colombia. I recommend her without reservation and am confident she will build a transformative campus presence for your institution.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'T. Wilke', written in a cursive style.

Prof. Dr. Thomas Wilke
Director of the Institute of Zoology